CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 23

Wynn *Pennywhistle*

PHOTOGRAPHER OF THE COSTUME PARADE



"You photograph every costume. Nobody notices the photographer."

FOR WYNN PENNYWHISTLE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 14+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

Dark clothes, a camera on a strap (a phone works) and a beret or cap worn backward.

Mask: a camera-lens mask: a circle of black card with a silver ring.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

> **If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.** You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper refused to let you sell copies of the parade photos and planned to give the museum all your old negatives.

YOUR SECRET

You have been selling the parade photos online anyway, for three years, under another name.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:20 to 8:50 you were alone in the portrait room upstairs, setting up lights and a backdrop for the winners' photo. The portrait room is up the main staircase, far from the Back Stairs.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep your photo sales quiet until Round 3.
- Find the best costume of the night.
- Help the Detective with your photographer's eye.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were upstairs in the portrait room from 8:20 to 8:50, setting up the winners' backdrop. You came down the main staircase when you heard shouting about the ghost. Your photographer's eye says: masks hide faces, not walks.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Can I see the Gazette camera photos?"

? Ask **Darcy Wickliffe:** "Did anyone touch up your gold face paint tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Pick your favorite costume and tell its wearer why.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

In the Gazette photos (Evidence #6), look at Jory's face: no mask, no paint. Masks pick up face paint like a sponge. If you find the fox mask, look inside it.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "How long had you worn your fox mask before you took it off?"

? Ask **Ainsley Duskwood:** "Did your black cloak ever leave the conservatory?"

YOUR TASK

> "Photograph" three suspects (pretend or real) and study their costumes.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

ROUND 3

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the photo sales. Then say that earlier this evening, at about 8:00, you photographed the Dipping Room demonstration: Marlo was wearing a long black cloak and fresh gold face paint dots. At 9:05, when everyone gathered in the ballroom, the dots looked smeared.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Why did your gold face paint look smeared at 9:05?"

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Who wore the most gold tonight?"

YOUR TASK

> Vote for Best Costume, then vote on the murder.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade